



Tuition Balance Emergency Action Plan

A 48-hour plan for holds, balances, payment deadlines, and enrollment risk.

MADE FOR

Students facing an urgent college balance

Use this toolkit as a planning guide. Requirements, deadlines, and availability are set by each school, scholarship, agency, or provider. EFF cannot guarantee funding or outside assistance.

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First 24 hours

- Download an itemized account statement
- List pending aid, outside scholarships, waivers, and credits
- Email financial aid, student accounts, and the dean of students together
- Ask about emergency, completion, retention, or institutional grants
- Ask whether a temporary hold, extension, or fee review is available
- Record names, dates, confirmation numbers, and promised follow-ups

DO NOT RUSH

Before withdrawing, ask in writing how it affects aid, satisfactory academic progress, housing, insurance, balances, and re-enrollment.

Balance-response email

SUBJECT

Urgent Account Review Request - Enrollment at Risk

Hello,

I am requesting a coordinated review of my account because a balance of \$[amount] may prevent my enrollment for [term]. I have already completed [FAFSA/payment/application steps]. Please confirm my itemized balance, pending aid, available emergency or completion funding, appeal options, and whether a temporary extension or hold review is possible while requests are pending.

My deadline is [date]. Please provide the next required action and response timeline in writing.

Thank you,

[Name] | [Student ID]

Backup support map

Need	First contacts
Food / essentials	Campus pantry, basic-needs center, 211
Housing / utilities	Campus housing, 211, local community action agency
Transportation	Dean of students, transit aid, workforce programs
Childcare	Campus family center, ChildCare.gov, state subsidy
Mental-health crisis	Call or text 988; immediate danger call 911